MBA603 Management, Leadership and Ethics – Unit Outline

Master of Business Administration | Graduate Certificate in Business Administration | Master of Cyber-Security

Administrative Details

Associated Course(s)	*Master of Business Administration; Graduate Certificate in Business Administration; Master of Cyber-Security*
Duration	*One Block (6 Weeks)*
Type	*Core*
Weighting	*6 credit points*
Workload per Week	*4 timetabled hours (Thursday 9:00–13:00), 7 hours personal study*
Delivery Mode	*On campus*
Requisites	*None*

Unit Overview

In this unit you will explore the theories of Leadership, Management, and Ethics and their application in contemporary business and organisational settings. You will gain an appreciation of your own leadership style and approach to management and reflect on your practice. This includes developing strategic thinking skills that support organisational dialogue to manage processes and, where necessary, lead change. An important aspect of leadership and management is the ability to approach decision-making in an ethical way given the conflicting demands of today's business and organisational environments. Major topic areas include organisational strategy, managing teams, leadership theory, motivation, managing communication, and ethical and social responsibility.

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this unit, you will be able to:

LO 1	Demonstrate an ability to relate management and leadership theory and practice to contemporary organisations in an increasingly dynamic and dispersed world.
LO 2	Describe management and leadership theory useful at the organisational level, to foster effective organisational dialogue to lead and manage people.
LO 3	Examine new models of leadership and management as a way of considering structural options for organisations.
LO 4	Critically examine the key concepts and theories associated with the study of ethics and their application to management and leadership in a contemporary business environment.
LO 5	Reflect upon own leadership style and approaches.
LO 6	Apply leadership skills within a small-team environment and in independent situations.

Unit Schedule

The following schedule is indicative. Your lecturer may adjust topics, readings, or activities to suit the cohort's needs. Assessment details, marking rubrics, and GenAI guidelines for each task will be made available on Moodle at least two weeks prior to unit commencement.

Week	Topic	Readings / Activities	Notes
1.1	Introduction to Management, Leadership and Ethics	*Chapter 1, Williams et al. (2023)*	
1.2	Organisational Environment and Cultures	*Chapter 3, Williams et al. (2023)*	
2.1	Managing Information	*Chapter 16, Williams et al. (2023)*	
2.2	Ethical and Social Responsibility	*Chapter 4, Williams et al. (2023)*	Assessment 1 due end of Week 2
#	**Assessment 1 Due — Case Study Analysis**	Submit via Moodle by end of Week 2	**20%**
3.1	Planning and Decision Making	*Chapter 5, Williams et al. (2023)*	
3.2	Organisational Strategy	*Chapter 6, Williams et al. (2023)*	
4.1	Managing Teams	*Chapter 10, Williams et al. (2023)*	
4.2	Team Presentations		Assessment 2 presentations
#	**Assessment 2 Due — Team Report and Self-Reflection**	Submit via Moodle by end of Week 4	**40% (20% Report + 20% Self-Reflection)**
5.1	Leadership	*Chapter 13, Williams et al. (2023)*	
5.2	Managing Communication	*Chapter 14, Williams et al. (2023)*	
6.1	Motivation	*Chapter 12, Williams et al. (2023)*	
6.2	Controlling	*Chapter 15, Williams et al. (2023)*	Assessment 3 due end of Week 6
#	**Assessment 3 Due — Leadership Study**	Submit via Moodle by end of Week 6	**40%**
7.1	Assessment Review		
7.2	Study Break		

Assessments

Each unit will have a minimum of two and a maximum of four assessment tasks, at least one of which must be summative. Students are required to submit ALL assessment tasks to be eligible to pass the unit. If any required assessment is not submitted, the final composite mark will be capped at 50% irrespective of other results. Detailed assessment briefs, marking rubrics, and GenAI guidelines for each task are available on Moodle.

#	Assessment Type	Weighting	Due	Learning Outcomes	Graduate Attributes
1	Case Study Analysis	20%	End of Week 2	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6	1, 2, 3, 6
2	Team Report and Self-Reflection *(20% Team Report + 20% Self-Reflection)*	**40%**	End of Week 4	4, 6	1, 2, 3, 6
3	Leadership Study	40%	End of Week 6	1, 2, 3, 5, 6	1, 6
	Total	**100%**		**1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6**	**1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6**

Assessment 2 comprises a Team Report (20%) and an individual Self-Reflection (20%), totalling 40%. This combined group/individual design is permissible where specific learning outcomes require collaborative work (Assessment Policy v1.1, §2.16). Students must complete the individual Self-Reflection component independently.

TIIS Graduate Attributes: https://tiis.edu.au/about-us/

TIIS Assessment Policy and Procedure v1.1: https://tiis.edu.au/tiis-policies/

Prescribed Text

Williams, C., McWilliams, A., Lawrence, R. and Waheduzzaman, W. (2023) *MGMT5*. Cengage AU.

Recommended Resources

Texts

- Antonakis, J. and Day, D.V. (2017) *The Nature of Leadership*. 3rd edn. SAGE, Thousand Oaks, CA.
- Covey, S.R. and England, B. (2012) *The 3rd Alternative: Solving Life's Most Difficult Problems*. Simon & Schuster, Sydney.
- Dubrin, A.J. (2018) *Leadership: Research Findings, Practice, and Skills*. 8th edn. Cengage Learning.
- Kouzes, J.M. and Posner, B.Z. (2017) *The Leadership Challenge: How to Make Extraordinary Things Happen in Organizations*. 6th edn. Wiley, Hoboken, NJ.
- Northouse, P.G. (2019) *Leadership: Theory and Practice*. 8th edn. Sage, Los Angeles.

Reference Journals

- Leadership
- Academy of Management Journal
- Administrative Science Quarterly
- Leadership Quarterly

- The Journal of Values-Based Leadership

Websites — Recommended TED Talks

- Roselinde Torres — What It Takes to Be a Great Leader
- Simon Sinek — Why Good Leaders Make You Feel Safe
- Simon Sinek — How Great Leaders Inspire Action
- Scott Dinsmore — How to Find Work You Love
- Barry Schwartz — The Way We Think About Work Is Broken
- Barry Schwartz — On Our Loss of Wisdom
- Alain de Botton — A Kinder, Gentler Philosophy of Success
- Dan Gilbert — Why Are We Happy?
- Dan Pink — On Motivation

Submission of Assessment Tasks

Unit outlines contain clear instructions on how, where, and when assessment tasks are to be submitted. It is each student's responsibility to ensure that assessments are submitted correctly, in the required format, and on time according to the instructions provided on Moodle. Assessments submitted in a format other than the one specified will not be marked.

Students are required to submit ALL assessment tasks in a unit in order to pass the unit. Every assessment task submitted must, in the view of the marker, be a serious attempt to meet the learning outcomes of the task, be the student's own work, and be declared so each time. If any required assessment is not submitted, the final composite mark a student can receive for the unit will be capped at 50% irrespective of their final assessment mark and grade.

Where the assessment submission exceeds the specified word count by 10% or more, a penalty of up to 25% off the maximum mark available will be applied. Papers of excessive length will not be read or receive feedback beyond the word limit plus 10%. No penalty applies to submissions below the word count; however, students should note that it may be difficult to demonstrate the required level of depth for a passing grade if the word count has not been met.

For in-class assessment activities (e.g. oral presentations, in-class quizzes, tutorial activities, and self-reflection tasks), no extensions will be permitted as these must be completed within the specified class time. Where a submission has a specified time limit, it will not be marked beyond that limit.

Extension of Assessment Task Due Date

An extension of the assessment deadline may be granted on the following grounds, with supporting documentation as appropriate (e.g. doctor's certificate, death certificate, or letter from a registered psychologist). The maximum extension that may be granted is five (5) days.

- Medical illness
- Extreme hardship
- Compassionate grounds
- Faculty-supervised project amendment

Applications for extensions must be lodged in writing through the Student Support Team at studentsupport@tiis.edu.au prior to the submission due date. All extensions are granted at the sole discretion of TIIS. An assessment will not be accepted once the approved extension submission date has passed.

In cases of repeated extension requests, students may be offered alternative forms of assistance (e.g. time management advice or academic skills support) in lieu of an extension. Students with exceptional circumstances will be considered on a case-by-case basis. Work commitments or activities associated with extending a visa or undertaking English language proficiency tests are not considered valid grounds for an extension.

Unavoidable Disruption

Where a student is prevented by an unavoidable disruption from both submitting an assessment and applying for an extension prior to the assessment deadline, the student shall report the circumstances in writing — with supporting documentation — to the Program Director as soon as practicable (generally no later than seven days after the assessment deadline). An unavoidable disruption is defined as resulting from an event or set of circumstances which:

- could not have reasonably been anticipated, avoided, or guarded against by the student; and
- was beyond the student's control.

Late Submission / Penalty

Students are expected to submit assessments by the due date. Students who do not submit assessments by the due date without an approved extension or unavoidable disruption are at risk of receiving a late penalty for that assessment. The standard late penalty is 10% of the maximum available mark for the assessment task per calendar day late. After 7 calendar days, a '0' (zero) will be recorded for that task. However, the student is still required to submit the task in order to pass the unit.

Variations to this penalty may be appropriate for certain units where the nature of the assessment warrants a different approach. Any such variation must be approved by the Dean or delegate, documented in the relevant unit outline, and communicated to students at least two weeks prior to unit commencement.

Please familiarise yourself with the TIIS Assessment Policy and Procedure: https://tiis.edu.au/tiis-policies/

Supplementary Assessments

There is no automatic right to receive a supplementary assessment task. To be eligible, all of the following must be met:

- All other assessment tasks in the unit must have been submitted.
- The student is not indebted to TIIS or is up to date with any payment plan they may have.
- The student must have a final mark of 47% to less than 50% for the unit.

If students meet the above requirements, they may apply for a supplementary assessment and pay the relevant fee. Failure to submit the supplementary assessment by the required time — including failing to attend an in-person assessment — will result in a mark of zero (0) and any fee paid will not be refunded. No extension or further assessment opportunity is available if the approved supplementary is missed.

Grading System

The following marking scale applies for each unit in accordance with the TIIS Assessment Policy and Procedure v1.1, Section 7. All fail grades will appear on the Academic Transcript, which will also include a Grade Point Average.

Grade	Mark Range	Definition
High Distinction (HD)	≥ 85%	Outstanding work exhibiting sophisticated understanding and critical synthesis, analysis, and evaluation of the subject matter. Judgements about the value of the subject matter are made and drawn together in an organised whole. Gaps in the subject matter may be identified with implications discussed.

Grade	Mark Range	Definition
Distinction (D)	75–84%	Substantial work of high quality demonstrating a clear understanding of the subject matter, in which the relationship between constituent elements is identified clearly and discussed with some level of critical analysis. The work also applies abstract ideas in concrete situations.
Credit (C)	65–74%	Sound and competent work demonstrating a reasonable but incomplete grasp of the subject matter. Recall and paraphrase the work of others with little integration. Some basic levels of critical analysis are evident.
Pass (P)	50–64%	Work that demonstrates a satisfactory engagement with the subject matter such that the student has a general understanding of the area of knowledge.
Pass – Supplementary (P(S))	50%	Student passes the unit based on the successful undertaking of a supplementary assessment. Maximum mark awarded is 50%.
Fail – Outright (FO)	< 50%	Attempted all or most of the assessments but did not meet key learning objectives of the unit.
Fail – Non-submission (FN)	≤ 15%	Did not submit more than 15% of the total value of assessments or did not submit any assessment task (0%).
Withdrew without Failure (WO)	—	Withdrew from the unit before census date or after census date with approved special circumstances.
Withdrew with Failure (WF)	—	Withdrew from the unit after the census date without approved special circumstances.
Result Withheld – Incomplete (RWI)	—	Result to be finalised (e.g. ongoing misconduct investigation, pending deferred or supplementary exam). Converts to FN if not resolved by the following teaching period.
Result Withheld – Administrative (RWA)	—	Student must resolve an issue with TIIS Administration before the grade is released.
Non-graded Pass (NGP)	—	Completion of an assessed task on a pass/fail basis.
Credit for Prior Learning (CPL)	—	Credit has been applied for and granted for prior learning.

Review of Assessment

Students who fail an assessment may obtain informal feedback from the Unit Coordinator, appeal for a re-mark, or re-enrol in the unit and pay the relevant fees. There is no automatic right to a remark, resubmission, or supplementary assessment task.

A formal re-mark request must be made in writing using the required form (specified in the relevant Student Handbook) within the appeals period after the release of the assessment grade and must include evidence as to why the student believes the grade was wrong or unfair. Re-mark requests must be accompanied by the re-marking fee. The Dean or delegate will determine whether a re-mark is justified. The re-marker may not be the original assessor and must have expertise in the relevant area and declare any conflicts of interest.

All re-marked assessments are subject to moderation where the re-marked mark varies by 10% or more from the original. The re-marked grade is final — whether higher or lower than the original. Only one re-mark per assessment is permitted. The re-mark fee may be refunded if the re-marked mark is 10% or more higher than the original and the overall unit grade increases.

Students dissatisfied after the re-marking process may lodge a formal appeal/grievance in accordance with the TIIS Complaints and Grievance Resolution Policy and Procedure. Such an appeal may only be made on the grounds that correct policies and procedures were not followed; it will not include a review of the assessment or unit grade.

Full details: TIIS Assessment Policy and Procedure v1.1, Section 9 — https://tiis.edu.au/tiis-policies/

Plagiarism and Academic Misconduct

TIIS views any form of academic misconduct as a serious offence. Academic misconduct in any form is not tolerated and will be dealt with according to policies and procedures approved by the Academic Board. Plagiarism occurs when one uses another person's ideas or manner of expressing them and passes them off as one's own work by failing to give appropriate acknowledgement. Re-mark requests for assessments found to be in breach of the Academic Integrity Policy and Procedure will not be accepted.

To support academic integrity, a random selection of submitted final assessments each term may require students to present a verbal summary and respond to questions. The student must verbally demonstrate sufficient knowledge of their submitted work to validate that it is their own. Students selected must attend at the agreed time; failure to attend will result in a zero for that assessment.

Students must comply with the writing and referencing conventions set out in the TIIS Style Guide (Harvard — Cite Them Right). Appropriate referencing is required whether consulting physical texts, online sources, or Generative AI tools. All relevant policies are located at:

https://tiis.edu.au/tiis-policies/

Student Use of Generative AI (GenAI) in Assessment

TIIS recognises that Generative AI (GenAI) tools are evolving rapidly and may be used in a range of contexts in higher education. Each unit specifies — in its outline and LMS site — whether GenAI tools are: (a) not permitted; (b) permitted with conditions (e.g. for specific tasks or stages only); or (c) permitted and encouraged. This specification is made available to students at least two weeks prior to unit commencement (Assessment Policy v1.1, §2A.2).

Where GenAI use is permitted, students must cite and acknowledge all GenAI tools used in accordance with the TIIS Style Guide. Students must apply significant original critical analysis, synthesis, and modification to any GenAI-generated content; verbatim or near-verbatim reproduction without transformation or attribution constitutes academic misconduct. If GenAI is used when not permitted, it will be treated as academic misconduct and penalties applied under the TIIS Academic Integrity and Misconduct Policy and Procedure.

GenAI Permissions for MBA603	
Assessment 1 — Case Study Analysis	*Not Permitted — This task requires students to demonstrate original critical thinking and independent analytical reasoning applied to a real-world business case. GenAI tools must not be used at any stage of the preparation or writing of this assessment.*
Assessment 2 — Team Report	*Permitted with Conditions — GenAI tools may be used for preliminary research and structural brainstorming only. All analysis, argument, and written content must be the original work of the team. Any use of GenAI must be disclosed using the TIIS GenAI Disclosure Template and referenced in accordance with the TIIS Style Guide.*
Assessment 2 — Self-Reflection	*Not Permitted — The Self-Reflection component requires authentic personal reflection on individual leadership style and*

	approaches (LO 5). This must represent entirely the student's own voice and experience. GenAI tools must not be used.
Assessment 3 — Leadership Study	*Permitted with Conditions — GenAI tools may be used for research exploration and literature identification only. All critical analysis, reflective commentary, and argument must be the student's own original work. Any use must be disclosed and referenced. GenAI may not be used to generate the self-assessment or reflective sections of this study.*

Use of Moodle

TIIS uses Moodle as its online teaching platform (MyTIIS). You have access to Moodle to view and/or download lecture material, assessment briefs, marking rubrics, grades, important announcements, and discussion forums. It is your responsibility to check Moodle and your TIIS-provided email on a regular basis and to have viewed lecture materials and additional readings before class. Should you have difficulties accessing Moodle, contact the TIIS IT Helpdesk: servicedesk@tiis.edu.au

Use of Learning Centre

You are expected to engage in additional independent research. Textbooks and teaching materials are available in the Learning Centre. You also have access to a wide range of electronic academic journals and databases — currently including ProQuest, Emerald Publishing, Accounting Research Network, DatAnalysis, SSRN, and Google Scholar — accessible once you log into Moodle. For assistance with ProQuest or online research, contact the Librarian, your lecturer, or TIIS IT.

Study Skills & Academic Support

If you have difficulties with your studies and/or specific forms of assessment, visit the Learning Centre. TIIS also offers regular free Academic Support via the Learning Centre. See details at TIIS.edu.au. Annotated assessment examples will be provided for each core unit by the relevant Unit Coordinator.

Student Support

Studying in higher education presents many experiences and challenges. These might involve academic, personal, and/or professional issues. At TIIS, we have a range of people who can help you. Students with special needs (including disability, impairment, or medical conditions) who require reasonable adjustments to assessment conditions or methods should contact Student Services as soon as practicable. Your first point of contact is the Student Support Officer — in person or via info@tiis.edu.au